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AFRICAN VISION MALAWI

CREATING LASTING CHANGE

Issue 35

Newsletter
Summer 2023

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Our Vision: A healthy, educated, self-sufficient community in Malawi

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Medical Outreach supports around 3,000 people per month





Emma Katengeza manages our health programmes, which have a positive impact on our community. Health care is not widely available, so our 10 medical outreach programmes reach up to 3,000 sick people each month. This programme is funded by Love Support Unite.

During the heavy rains, the large ambulance is the only vehicle that can reach some of the remote villages we work in. These outreach programmes are so important to people who cannot reach the local clinics, as they provide HIV and malaria testing, vaccines, family planning, and under-5 clinics. For example, in March, we reached 3,516 people.

HEALTH

SEND (Special Educational Needs & Disability) and SMU (Safe Motherhood Unit) Stakeholders meeting .On June 7th, we held a stakeholders meeting with community, district, and NGO stakeholders to discuss our proposals for the SEND and SMU programme, which we hope to start building this year. 35 people attended, and after the presentation at Sam's Village, we visited the clinic and school site where the two units will be implemented. It is very important to identify special needs children early, and the maternity unit will provide this. Early intervention and follow-up can then be provided through the under-5s clinics and our therapy units.



VULNERABLE BENEFICIARIES

Our aim is to try and make people self-sufficient, but this can sometimes be difficult if they have special needs. We have a number of vulnerable people who don't have a sponsor to support them. If you feel you would like to support them, please contact us at info@africanvision.org.uk Jennifer (below left) is 13 and supported by us since she was 6 and has a prosthetic leg. Her cousin (centre photo) has the same genetic disorder and needs supporting. Zozo (far left) visited his home village, but has returned to Sam's Village as it is too challenging for him to support himself.











SAM'S VILLAGE



Four of our previous carpentry graduates from last year and their trainer made us 40 chairs at Sam's Village. Work has been ongoing to complete Sam's Village and a solar hot water geyser has been installed in the River Block Finishing touches to the Tree Block are also being made. We are looking forward to more training at Sam's. We shall be holding Project Management training in October. If any organisation is interested in joining this training, contact info@africanvision.org.uk. Our grounds are covered in permaculture gardens and original indigenous trees which is fantastic. You can see Kondwani and Felix at their seed bank below.






Photos—chairs above. (left to right) Tree Block finishing touches, Kondwani and Felix at their seed bank cupboard, edible carpark demarcations, Aloe Vera plants in flower.

STAFF, VOLUNTEERS & PARTNERS



The Pakhanias family (left) visited Chitsime School in March. They are connected with The Mall Preparatory School which is partnered with Malawi.



V&S group from Ireland (right) came to Malawi in May for 2 weeks to build a washroom at M'bang'ombe school to encourage girls to stay at school. This trip was postponed from 2020 due to Covid. We were so happy to have Colin and Paul back in Malawi with us. Thanks to Wezie Gwaluka for taking good care of them!



We welcome Joe Msiska (left) who joined us in April as our Finance Manager. We are looking forward to working together with him to move us forward in supporting vulnerable people.

We say a sad farewell to Princess Mwale (left below) who has been supporting our Educational programmes for 4 years under Wezie Gwaluka. We wish her well in her future.



We are grateful to Jacob Palmer (right), who volunteered at Sam's Village in May. He painted a mural for the Tree Block and collaborated with our beneficiaries, school children, and the local band on a music project.Paul Forkan (bottom right), from the Gandys Foundation, visited Malawi for five days to see the Funsani Early Childhood Development Center, which they funded in 2017. It was a great visit!





We welcome our new Malawi Trustees, Duncan Chiyani and Maria Moyo (bottom left). Both previously worked for AVM as Country Manager and Deputy Country Manager, respectively.




EDUCATION

Scholarship programme





Martha Chaguzika (left) is one of our scholarship students who attended vocational training in tailoring. With the help of a starter pack, she started a business from her home in Lilongwe and is now producing some amazing clothing! Abraham Banda and Julius Zerezere graduated in March from Chancellor College and The Polytechnic, respectively. Both students were studying Bachelor of Education and Bachelor of Technical Education, and they have passed their final exams. They will now be posted to government secondary schools to teach. Julius said *'Please pass regards to my sponsors, tell him I will forever be grateful for his support"*

'Early Childhood Development (ECD)





During March & April a kind benefactor contributed funds for us to buy nutritional porridge for our 12 Early Childhood Development centres, during the 'hungry months'. We shall be growing 3 sustainable ECD Food gardens later this year from further funds from the benefactor. Our grateful thanks for his kindness. This food encourages children to come to the centres to learn.





School Partnerships - We created a new school partnership with Kakoma Primary and St Pauls Catholic Primary on 12th May (left). It was a successful event and AVM are joining St Pauls for their 'Malawi Day' on 20th June. Our school partnerships are curriculum based and the next theme is 'weather & climate change' which is very apt after the enormous devastating effect of Cyclone Freddy on Southern Malawi earlier this year.



AGRICULTURE

We are promoting organic and sustainable ways of growing food through permaculture gardens. We have trained 40 households in this technique, which provides them with nutritious food right on their doorstep.



We also have Sustainable Family Farms, where 10 of the farmers (below left)managed to harvest around 4-5 tonnes of maize each this year. The selected families are all vulnerable and care for orphans, the elderly, and people with disabilities. They pay back the seed loan, which goes to support another family. This programme is funded by Love Support Unite.



Earlier this year, 2,800 trees were planted (right). Our goal is to plant 10,000 trees per year over the next four years. If you want to offset your carbon emissions, a tree costs £2.50. Help fight climate change!



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African Vision Malawi
31 Upper Brighton Road
Surbiton
Surrey, KT6 6QX

Phone: 020 8287 8169

info@africanvision.org.uk

Charity no: 1113786

THANKS TO:
INQ.DIGITAL MALAWI
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OUR MALAWI TEAM
500 MILES
ALL SAINTS KNITTERS
TRUSTEES
GANDYS FOUNDATION
ST MATTHEW'S CHURCH
EILEEN SPEAK
GAYNOR COOK
PARTNERSHIP SCHOOLS
HEATHER CUMMINS
JANE THOMPSON
ST MARY'S CHURCH
BRIAR HILL INFANTS
MARIE BROWN

Hungry months food distribution

Although we are working hard on our sustainable agricultural programmes we are still finding it necessary to distribute food to vulnerable people in the 'hungry months' of January, February and March. This is to ultra-poor, elderly and disabled people. We distributed food packs in January and reached 280 people in total providing 20kg of maize each.





FUNDRAISING EVENTS

Indulgence Day—June 17th Please come and join us for our Annual fundraising event with lots of therapists, stalls, music and fun to be had! 10am—6pm at 31 Upper Brighton Road, Surbiton, Surrey, KT6 6QX

Pedal Power May 2024 — 10 day trip. Cycle 500km over 6 days, 2 days off including a safari, and 2 days looking at our programmes. An experience of a lifetime. £2,100 (includes local transport, accommodation, food, guide, bike hire, safari, visit cave paintings and backup support). If you would like to know more please email info@africanvision.org.uk.

Recent events:

Art exhibition—'Woman is airborne' by artist Cilla Taylor. We raised £360 towards reforestation

Panto stall and collection—In February we raised £1,650

Music for Malawi evening in March— raised £1,370. Our grateful thanks to Fred Hills Music, Gambling Hearts and Jacob Palmer

A big 'thank you' to **The cornerHOUSE** who provided the space for the 3 above events free of charge!



Golf Marathon—in June a Golf marathon was organised by Andrew Ridgley-Barker, who is one of our Trustees and made an incredible £12,000! Our grateful thanks to everyone that took part!

We are very grateful for our School Partnership links. We have 24 links in UK with 22 schools in Malawi (1 pre-school). We have had a donation from Briar Hill Infant School for £600 for their partnership school, Kafutwe Primary in Malawi. Thanks for making a difference!

We have a new partnership with St Pauls Catholic Primary School, Thames Ditton, and Kakoma Primary School. More information in our next newsletter!